

Lab 06 - Pen, Curvature, Pencil and Brushes

Course: Adobe Illustrator Fundamentals for Beginners (C037) Version: v1 | 4 October 2026

Scenario

Produce a mascot mark with a precise silhouette and an expressive supporting stroke.

Objective

Create controlled and expressive paths while keeping anchor economy and brush behaviour visible.

Supplied Illustrator/vector files

- Brush.ai
- drawingPractice.ai
- Pencil.ai
- PenTools.ai

Detailed procedure

1. Open PenTools.ai and save Lab06-Path-Control.ai.
2. Trace one straight and curved form with the Pen tool using the fewest practical anchors.
3. Create a Curvature-tool alternative and compare smooth and corner-point handling.
4. Use Pencil settings to draw an expressive supporting path and smooth only where required.
5. Apply or create an appropriate brush; test scale, direction and colourisation behaviour.
6. Overlay the alternatives, inspect for kinks or noise and export the selected mark with an anchor-count note.

Evidence to retain

AI master with Pen, Curvature and Pencil alternatives plus exported selected mark.

Acceptance criteria

- [] Curves are smooth and economical.
- [] Corner points appear only where intended.
- [] Brush direction and scaling are correct.
- [] The selected method is justified by visible evidence.

Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers or Appearance panel prove that your technique remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?